

Week 10: Video Transcript

Hello everyone and welcome back. This is Rebecca Lyddon of the Jai Institute for Parenting, as you know, and we are here for our 10th class. Today we are discussing anger and healthy aggression. Dun dun dun... and I'm going to invite all of us listening to this audio, engaging in this workbook, working in a circle, working with a personal coach, that we keep an open mind and we stay curious. Anger and aggression are probably the most tender topics in the parenting world right now, because so many of us carry wounds around this topic. So many of us live with shame around our emotional reactivity and our anger. So many of us live in fear around anger and we avoid it at all costs, or we find ourselves struggling with anger daily. Parents who yell, parents who are impatient, parents who are irritable, parents who say things to their children that they can't believe that that came out of their mouth. And I'm wanting us to be so soft and gentle with ourselves, compassionate, and again, curious that we are relearning what anger is. We are taking it out from under the bed, it's not the boogeyman. We are seeing it for what it is, and we are relearning what healthy aggression is, why it's here, how it serves, and how it's actually incredibly healing and beneficial to our humanity if we understand it, and know how to interact and be in relationship with it.

So we are going to have an exciting and fulfilling conversation. Today, you have a workbook to accompany this video. If you'd like to have it out, or it can be two separate things for you. We're going to discuss how anger and aggression is very connected to boundaries. We discussed last week, the peace process, boundaries, and limits from family values, and I'd love to go back and recap what we discussed last week and show you how anger and aggression is so interconnected. So a nice deep breath as we get into this conversation and trust that we are going to get through this, and you're going to learn and have an expansive perspective. You're grounded, you're rooted, you're safe, and you're present. Let's get started.

Last week we discussed the peace process, which is a five step process in the empowered parenting paradigm that is used as a response, a map of responsivity, to any kind of parenting scenario. And I really mean any kind of parenting scenario. I've had clients with children in their forties, fifties, sixties, and they're having interactions with these older children and the pattern and the habit of interaction for decades and decades and decades has been power over or power under.



We have clients learning this peace process with these older children and their interactions are flowing so much more smoothly, and they are connecting in a much deeper way. So the peace process can work for any kind of adult interactive scenario. It can work for children in their twenties, children in their teens who are not coming home on time for their curfew, sneaking out of the house, or having difficulty following through on their homework commitment. It could be for tweens that are struggling with screen time. Social interaction could be for youngsters struggling with anything, because there's a lot of struggle for young children. Sibling squabbles, any kind of conflict needing resolution and support. This peace process is there for you. Like I've mentioned in the last video, this is a combination of all of these fantastic concepts that we have learned together so far, and that the peace process isn't something that works or not works. This is a process of repairing disconnection, and from the reparation of disconnection, we have a foundation of stability, security, safety, and secure attachment. From a secure attachment, the rest of this peace process flows, the rest of the tools and the frameworks that you have learned blossom. We can communicate, we can verbally empathize. We can non-verbally empathize. We can reiterate boundaries from values. We can have conscious, intentional communication to understand, and we can problem solve, collaborate, and co-create the path moving forward with our children. I am also wanting to discuss the boundary from family values.

We learned that when we have a very clear value beneath our boundary, we're going to be able to be much more present, ANCHORed, emotionally available, trusting, and patient. There's so much disorienting energy within a parent when they don't understand in their own self, why they struggle with a boundary or a limit or a rule that they have. Their children are demanding "Why?", and the parent doesn't have an answer. Instead of saying to our child, "You know, I actually don't know why I have this rule. I think it's coming from my personal conditioning of my own childhood. There's a whole lot of fear there and a whole lot of shame and scarcity. I think that's why I have this boundary and this rule." Most of us are not willing to divulge that with our children, because we don't want to be seen as vulnerable, lacking the answers, and not confident. Much of the time for so many clients and parents and myself, even at moments, we all struggle having boundaries with our children that we can stand sure-footed in with a sense of stillness in our bodies. We can deliver the boundary, we can state the limit, and we're not in danger in our system. Our alarm bells are not going off. We're clear. We're confident.

I'll give a very silly example from my morning. My son wanted chocolate and it was breakfast time and mama's words were, "It's breakfast time and in our home, we do not have chocolate before breakfast". My son melted and melted for probably 45 minutes, just releasing his disappointment, his grief, his frustration.



As his mother, I see that he's feeling sorrow, he's feeling frustration, disappointment, as I just named. He's having needs in this moment like autonomy, pleasure, spontaneity, and discovery. What else is fulfilled by chocolate? So many things! So many things are fulfilled by chocolate! So I'm aware I have empathy and compassion for this person. It's not just a want, it's not just a sugar craving. I understand that everything that we're wanting, it is a symbol of what it is we're needing. So for our children, we're wanting to be able to differentiate a want from a need. Wants are the strategies that we take to fulfill the need. Our children are not able to differentiate a want from a need. They don't have the emotional awareness. They don't have the vocabulary. They don't have the maturation in their psyche, in their personhood. We do, ideally. That's what we're learning together. We have that language. So I'm able to empathize with him and say, "Yeah, you really want that chocolate. You're wanting the chocolate and you're really longing to make your own choices. Wouldn't it be amazing if when you woke up in the morning, you could just chocolate, you could eat chocolate all morning and you never had to eat your breakfast? Oh, wouldn't that be amazing? So I'm able to let him know, I see you, I hear you, I feel you, I get you, and no. I'm very clear and I'm very confident in this.

There was a teeny tiny moment in that example with my son this morning, where I thought, "Why am I saying no to this? Am I just being rigid? Am I being inflexible? Am I not willing to really slow down, pause, and question myself, why am I saying no to this?" So there was a moment of reflection for me, and it happened really quickly because I've been doing this for so many years. But for some of you, you may need to really slow down and say, "Wow, why am I saying no? Why do I have this boundary? Is this really something I'm willing to stand for? Is this really coming from truth for me?" And in my home, it is very much coming from truth, because if my son has chocolate before breakfast, he doesn't eat his breakfast. Trial and error. Yay I figured it out! No chocolate before breakfast. So I was able to reflect very quickly in my own body and then deliver him a "no", and I was very confident, very clear. It was coming from values of health. It was coming from protection. It was coming from a longing for him to have nutrients, to be nourished. And I had the capacity because I had such clarity to hold him in his disappointment and grief.

So we're going to get into anger and aggression, and you may already be intuiting how connected this is because when our children hear a "no", so much of their anger and aggression comes out with a, "no." "Mommy, can I have chocolate?" "Oh, sweetie. It's not chocolate time. It's breakfast time". [Child meltdown noises] "Mom, can I borrow the car today to pick up my friend and go downtown for -- (whatever it is that teenagers do)?" "Oh, sorry sweetheart. I need to use the car today because I have an appointment on the other side of town".



And then it's like, "I never get it back, blah, blah, blah", whatever it is that they do in response to a no. And I'm sure you can relate. How do you feel when you hear a no to what it is you're wanting? Well, if you are an avoidant attachment, if you have those patterns, that's not just who you are. That's not your label. But if you experience life through the lens of an insecure attachment, specifically avoidant attachment, when you hear a no, your response might be something like, "Well, whatever it doesn't matter anyway. Yeah. That's fine. No, it's totally fine. Yeah. You take the car, I don't need it. I'll figure out another way." And you may be parading and performing this person who can, "Oh, it's totally fine", and we're going to learn in your workbook that that relationship with anger is called flight. So it's like, "I don't want to feel anger. I'm not willing to feel disappointment or grief. So I'm just going to say it doesn't matter."

If you're somebody who has more of an insecure ambivalent attachment, and we're going to call this the fight relationship with anger, then when you hear a "no", you're going to flip out and you're going to say things like, "You only care about yourself. I don't get to do anything that I want to do. I'm at home all day with the kids, then you come home, and then I can't go see my friend for an hour". It's going to be that reactivity. It's going to be vocalizing. It's going to be aggressive in your stance. You're going to get really rooted and stubborn. You're going to clench your fists, clench your jaw, and that's me, so I really resonate with this one. Hello, I'm a fight relationship with anger. I'm very clear. I'm very open. So our children have the same thing, or there's a third relationship with anger, which is shrink. So this is the melting into powerlessness and grief. So if the child hears a "no", or they hear a limit of any kind, any kind of limitation on their curiosity, exploration, and wonder. They're looking around the world like anything is possible. "Oh, I have these desires. I have this vision and I have this longing. I have this fantasy. And then I have this parent who's putting limitation on me. It's incredibly frustrating".

It's like being in traffic and you keep hitting red light and you're trying to get somewhere and you're late. That's what it feels like for children to hear a "no", or to hear a boundary or a limit, especially if that boundary or a limit is not coming from your authentic value, but a conditioned value. So let's say, I've lived a long time -- I'm going to talk about the shrink response more -- but I lived a long time in fear around the screen. I'm a recovering Waldorf teacher and if you know what I mean, then you know what I mean, where screens are evil. Screens are here to destroy relationships. And I'm exaggerating, so if you are a Waldorf teacher, absolutely I bow to you and this is beautiful, and this was my own experience. I'm not representative of Waldorf education *disclaimer*. So I lived in a lot of fear around screens and anytime my child saw a screen, I went into panic. I couldn't breathe and I had so much terror, and my boundaries around the screen was coming from terror.



It was coming from noise around me, people telling me what to do, people telling me what the right thing is, all of the articles on the internet that are absolutely terrifying about the effects of the screen on the developing brain. I was a very, very, very insecure person creating a boundary. So when my child was asking me for a screen and I was trying to say no, and I was trying to be confident, and I was really wanting to support them in their disappointment and their grief, I was on fire. So I wasn't able to support my child through their very emotionally and developmentally appropriate response to a limit.

So remember the prefrontal cortex, the neocortex, the front of the brain does not fully develop until around the age of 30. So until the age of 30, we are in this practice place of receiving "no", of receiving limits. We are not going to be very graceful in our response, especially under the age of seven, eleven, and eighteen. We're going to struggle with "no's", with the feeling of disappointment and the complexity of anger, disappointment, rage, frustration, grief, sorrow, all of those emotions are swirling around in our body when we hear a "no" or experience a limit that we perceive as infiltrating, intruding upon our autonomy, our independence, our life force energy, our willpower, et cetera.

Ok so rewind. The third relationship with anger is to shrink. So that's the melting into helplessness and powerlessness. That could be you or your child falling down on the floor and just becoming a big puddle and saying, "I never get anything that I want". So that's usually when things start to fly. So the child is melted on the floor and they never ever get anything that they want, and "you don't love me". My son was telling me today when he didn't get the chocolate. He's practicing his threats, which I find just super-duper cute and it calls me out on when I unconsciously threaten him, so I'm still learning also. He said, "if you don't give me chocolate, then I'm never going to love you anymore". I said, "Oh wow, that's deep". I didn't say that out loud, but I said that in my mind. When our children say those kinds of things to us like, "I'm not going to love you anymore. You're mean" or "I hate you, you are the meanest mommy" or whatever it is that they're saying at whatever age, that's their inability to say, "I am completely flooded with complexity of emotion. That's so uncomfortable for me that all I can do in this moment to cope and to survive is to throw these little lifesavers out." When they are verbally thrusting out their anger and aggression onto us, I see it as just my son, trying to make it through. I see it as his best attempt to make it through this really difficult moment for him. I do not take it personally. Please, if you want to survive your parenting, anything your child says when they're dysregulated in intense emotion verbally, do not take it personally. And that's a practice. That's a lifelong practice. Anything that they're saying, it's just water on a window pane. It's just melting. You are able to receive and it melts through you, this is called containing.



So this is all connected. I kind of feel like I'm a firework right now and I'm all over the place, but this is very connected because what we're wanting to be able to model to our children is that we can contain our anger. "Woah, my body is overcome with anger right now. Wow. This feels really intense. I feel really tingly all over myself and I feel like exploding. I feel like screaming. I feel like running. I feel like you could cook a marshmallow over my head and it would probably burn. And I get to choose how I express my aggression". So let's segue into this. Anger and aggression are married. They've been in a very unhealthy marriage for a very long time, I'd say thousands of years. As humans, we have a tainted relationship with our understanding, correlation, and our association of anger and aggression. For most of us, we see anger as equaling violence. We see anger as equaling somebody going deep inside, withdrawing, and giving you the silent treatment for three weeks. We see anger as melting down and becoming this helpless, powerless, catatonic, depressive place where you're stuck in for months or even years. We fear anger because we have no idea, at this time for most of us, how to be in a right relationship with aggression.

Right relationship means it's nutritive, it's flowing back and forth. I have choice, I have access to how I want to engage this aggressive energy. I understand it, accept it, and embrace it with safety in my body and expansive beliefs that aggression is my life force energy. Aggression is my will to live. You have aggression and the more you can be in security with your aggression, the more courageous you are going to be. The more you are going to look at this parenting stuff and say, "I'm not happy with this. I'm going to make a change". And then you're going to wake up and you're going to actually do it. You're not just going to talk about it. You're not going to complain about it. You're not going to be a victim to your life at this time. And I say that there's nothing wrong with being a victim. There are many people who are actually victims to circumstances. There are many people who are in relationships, work, intimate, familial situations that are not safe for them, so that is the actual legitimate victimhood. That's not what I'm talking about. So if that's bringing up any pain in your body, any memory of being a victim, and I believe that being raised in the power over or under parenting paradigm, at one time, we were all victims.

If that was how you were raised, and it's not because your parents are terrible people, it's nothing to do with your parents. This is conditioning that's generations old. At one time we were victims. We were powerless. We were helpless. We didn't have a voice. We didn't have a say. We didn't have choice. We didn't have equality. We were raised in a silent agreement that children should be seen and not heard. Children are born bad. Children are manipulative. Children only want attention and they suck the bone dry of their parents. They're needy. They're spoiled.



That's what we were raised in. I see that as victimhood for many of us, and we carry that in our bodies, but what I'm wanting us to be able to reclaim, remember, and embrace is that anger is good. Anger is okay. It's neutral. It's actually not even good. It just is. Anger is not good. It's not bad. It is. Aggression is not good or bad. It is. And we're not wanting to live in fear, we're wanting to live in freedom and choice. So we're learning that a lot of our anger comes up when we are met with a "no", or our child is met with a "no", a limit, a boundary, or any kind of punishment or enforced consequences, our children are going to get angry when we parent them in the power over or under parenting paradigm. They're not going to like it. The more that we're bringing our judgments, fear, control, coercion, manipulation, consequences, and all of the stuff that we dump onto our children, they're going to fight it. And good for them, good for them for fighting it. Children are so brave. They are so dedicated to their truth. They are so dedicated to being treated with respect and dignity. If you know me out in the world, I am all about the paradox. I'm all about the both and the and, that is a life identity that I embrace.

And the paradox of anger is courage. It's being so connected to your willpower. We're learning that the more often we are engaging with healthy aggression when we're calm and safe in our body and secure with ourselves and our children, where we can model healthy aggression, then our brains are going to prune. Meaning those neuro pathways, the neural networks that connect anger to violence are going to disappear. We're no longer going to see our five year old or our seven year old or our two year old, or even our twelve year old, when they're in their aggression because they're angry and they don't have the ability to contain it without modeling and space holding. We're not going to have any fear. We're not going to see this child as violent. We're not going to see this child and be afraid that we're raising a monster. We're not going to see our child and think, "What am I doing wrong that's creating this insanity?" We're no longer going to be afraid of this normal, natural expression of our humanity, and so our children are no longer going to be terrified of their anger and their aggression. We're wanting to model a secure, healthy, trusting relationship with anger and aggression so our children's body, their neuroception, their nervous system, their brain, their neural pathways, their thought processes, their emotional maturity, and intelligence is going to experience anger and not be terrified of it. It's when we are terrified of our anger that we go into fight.

Of course our children are aggressive when they have cortisol and adrenaline pumping through their body and their parent is looking at them with judgment and terror. That's terrifying. So when we see our children in their anger and when they're hitting, biting, kicking, whatever it is that they're doing, I plead of you to soften your labels around your child. They're not violent. They're not evil. They're not possessed. They're not a monster.



They're a child and they're needing you to be the role model of safety and security. The more that we are understanding our belief system around anger, the more that we're understanding and creating a coherent narrative on our associations with anger based on how we witnessed it as children, how we experience it now, and how we want to experience anger and aggression in the future, that's going to support us to be a neutral, safe space, and to be able to just be quiet. Just be quiet when your child or children is experiencing anger, because under anger is all of these more tender emotions.

When the child hears the word "no", it's like rejection. This is very relevant for siblings. You know, when, especially if your children are born less than five years apart or less than three, because we know that the first three years of a child's life is when they're creating that secure attachment with their parent. If another child is born within that three-year window, in that little baby physiology and brain who is here to survive, they're only thinking about how can I make it through these first three years, the most vulnerable first years of a human's life. If another child comes into the picture, they see that as a threat to their life. So many people struggle with sibling squabbles, "The three-year-old is hitting the baby and oh my God, what's wrong with my three-year-old". There's nothing wrong with your three-year-old. They're trying to live and they see this baby as this threat to their survival. So if you have children, even if they're eight and five now, it's still there. It's still there in that eight year old system, there is this little other person who came in and started taking the food, started taking my protector away from me. I didn't have as much time alone with my primary caregiver. My example of security and safety has been borrowed away from me and I don't have it as often. So there's a lot of aggression that goes onto siblings, especially younger siblings, because that is that older sibling's expression of protection of their life. So I hope that this is making sense. This is a big mind shift away from how we have been handling aggression and anger in our children.

So much of it has been behavioral modification. How do we make our children control their anger? How do we make them stop being aggressive? That's not the goal at all. We're actually wanting our children to be able to be in healthy aggression. So I have a lot of examples in our workbook. I have all kinds of YouTube videos for you. This is very cutting edge, let's say. This is very new in this conversation, in this arena, and so we're all really learning how to do this. And so my son, again, I like to say that he is a baby professional football player. So let me tell you all of these pro athletes that run into each other, all of those people were children at one time and they had mothers. God bless all those mothers who raise those sons because I'm doing that right now. So I have a professional football player, he's three and he's here to save the world, lift cars, and move boulders. And if he is not engaged with life and his ginormous will, then he's hitting people.



He's hitting people and he's biting, scratching, screaming, and he's fumbling and bumbling about. So I know that this child was born with this fire in his body to express itself in the world, and it's my job as his parent to see him and really understand his needs. My son needs to be engaged with an activity where he is exerting his willpower and his energy at all times.

So let's talk more about tender needs and anger and aggression. We've got about six minutes left in this video. I won't keep you here for too long, I'm all over the place. So tender needs based off of the work of Nonviolent Communication and this beautiful organization called Wiseheart PDX, you can look them up on the internet. They call tender needs as needs that we have that have been chronically unmet, decades long of being unmet. They are very, very tender for us. We have association with these needs of insecurity and our anger comes up when we perceive that these tender needs are being threatened. So what does this have to do with my child needing to be engaged in an activity at all times? Well, I am seeing my son struggling with sitting still, being calm. He needs to be engaged in life. We live on a farm, we live in the country. He needs to be out in life at all times. If I were to not be able to have the consciousness of these needs, if I were instead stuck in fear, labeling, wanting to modify his behavior to fit into a container that I believe that he should be fitting in, then his needs for authenticity, his need to be seen, heard, and understood, his need to be valued, appreciated, encouraged, accepted would go unmet.

Chronically, daily in his life he would be misunderstood, mislabeled. His life force energy would be suppressed. It would be oppressed. It would be subdued. He would probably lose his mind. And fast forward that into the future, let's say my son is eight and he wants chocolate before breakfast and I am not willing to see beneath his request, at his needs, at what's really happening for him deep down, so his need for understanding in that moment is going unmet. And it has been going chronically unmet because I haven't been able to really understand this person. I've been stuck in fear, judgment, and labels. Then that "no" is going to unleash years of grief, years of "You don't understand me. You don't listen to me. You don't care about me. I don't get anything that I want", and has nothing to do with the chocolate.

So many parents will come to me and say, "Oh my God, I gave my son or my daughter a red cup and they wanted a blue cup and it's just a cup! Why are you freaking out?" And I'll say it has absolutely nothing to do with the cup. What does the cup symbolize?



What actual needs in that moment, deep down beneath the surface, were not being seen, heard, acknowledged, understood, appreciated, accepted, and let's look at the timeline of this child's life. How long have these specific needs been chronically unmet? Your child's response, danger in the body, "I'm going to get this need unmet again. I don't know how much longer I could survive without this need being met". It's going to come out in anger and aggression.

We're going to go back to the, what do you do? What do you do when your child is hitting, scratching, throwing, biting, raging, and you have other children to protect or you're out in public? What are you supposed to do in those moments? And of course, our first step is to ANCHOR into truth. "My child is having a physiological response. He's going into fight. This is normal. This is what humans do. This is fine. This is normal. This is natural. This is healthy. We're going to get through this". Every time we support our child without fear, without judgment, without control, without all of our pain and wounds onto that moment, they're going to learn how to contain their anger. Ideally, this would have been happening since your child was a year old, but for most of us, it's just now starting. Your child might be twelve, or your child might be eighteen, and they don't know how to experience anger in their body, they still go into aggression, and you may go into aggression as the adult. So when we see our child in aggression, we're wanting to ANCHOR ourselves, and we're wanting to ANCHOR them.

This is very similar to the nervous system week that we discussed together. I'm bringing anger and aggression up again specifically because it is the most scary and intimidating topic for parents to see your child in aggression. All of these memories come flooding back of our experience as children in our homes around anger and aggression. So once we ANCHOR, we're safe in our body, this is natural. This is normal. This is developmentally appropriate. This is not who my child is. My child is going to develop, they're going to mature. This is right here right now. Accept. Accept your job as a parent, the most sacred, beautiful, precious job on the planet, is to surround your child with safety and acceptance, and I can feel the skepticism out there and the resistance to this language. And if that's you, that's absolutely fine. I think that you acknowledging skepticism and resistance is very healthy and it's utterly important that you're voicing the skepticism and resistance to your coach because we're able to look underneath it and really understand what's happening for you. So this is the game of awareness. I'm not trying to indoctrinate you or convince you of anything. I'm offering and I'm hoping that things are stirring up in you, that you're willing to discuss and communicate to anybody who will listen, especially someone who's trained to look beneath your behavior, your thought processes, your languaging.



We're ANCHORing ourselves for ANCHORing our child. If possible, you're removing the child from the situation that they're in, we're switching environments like, "Let's go get some air". If they're not able, if they're belligerent in their anger and they're punching you, kicking you, or hitting you, then you're going to know what your child's calming sensory tool is more than me. My son's is, I'm taking his flailing arms and I'm putting them down by his body and I'm giving him a tight hug and I'm bouncing him, and I'm taking him outside. And he might be saying, "Stop it. Let me go. I don't want to be outside. Stop it, go away, stop it", but because he and I have talked outside of the angry moments, "When you feel that anger in your body and your arms start swinging, you remember how mommy will grab you and I'll shush you. And you'll tell me, mommy, stop mommy, go away. Mommy I don't want this, and I'm wondering, is that what you really mean in that moment? Or are you wanting mommy to hold you?" And he'll tell me "I'm wanting you to hold me".

So I know that those words that he's saying is that rain on a window pane experience where he's trying to throw himself a lifesaver, his verbal aggression in that moment, his asserting of that language is not actually real for him. It's not what he's really wanting, it's just coming out. He doesn't have a filter. What he's probably actually saying is, "I hate this feeling in my body. I want this feeling in my body to go away", but he doesn't have the development in his consciousness so he's saying, "I want you to go away. I want you to stop", but he's probably talking to his anger. He's probably talking to the hormones flooding through his body. So I ANCHOR myself and I understand and accept the reality of what this is. This is the peace process also, acknowledging what is true is the "A", accepting what is happening is the "A". Being present, being connected to emotion, I'm not trying to talk to my child very much. If my child is in anger and aggression, I'm not saying, "Oh my goodness, I know you're disappointed and you really wanted that chocolate, you're so sad and you don't want to eat your breakfast..." because that overstimulates, it can. Some children it doesn't, but for my child it's overstimulating sensorily, especially children with any kind of sensory processing diversities, which is every child. He struggles to hear language. I'm not talking in those moments. I don't have any words coming out of my mouth, it's just a shush. He's almost four, so you're going to know how you can do this to a 10 year old? We're going to explore that, that's what this work is. This work is figuring out the plan that is the most supportive for you and your child in their anger and aggression moments, and then you feeling safe enough to be its facilitator. So if you don't have a plan, that's why you're working with a coach. Your coach is going to help you create a plan and there's trial and error, it's not perfect, it's still messy, and we're all learning together. Once my child is calm, that's when I would verbally empathize with him. "I understand how your body was feeling so intensely because you wanted something and you didn't get it. Yeah."



I'm not needing to teach him a lesson. I'm not needing to remind him that it's not okay to hit. I'm not needing to tell him that he gets to feel angry, but he doesn't get to hurt Mommy. That's just not appropriate in that moment. What's appropriate in that moment is "I'm here and you're safe". Once that moment has passed and y'all are playing, you're connecting, that's when we're going to be bringing in the playful parenting that we're going into next week. We're bringing in how you could tell a story to your child about this and incorporate the teaching of, for example, a bunny who was really angry and they remembered in that moment that their mommy told them when they're angry, they exhale. [Exhale noises]. And that helps them to not use their bunny paws and to hit their brother. The bunny felt so proud of himself for being able to catch his paws before they bounced out of his body." And we're wanting to teach our children in a way that they can comprehend and internalize, which is storytelling and play. I believe that that's true for any person, this is not just children. The human language -- that again, we're going to talk all about this -- the human language of learning is through play. Auditorily, visually kinesthetically, the different of learnings, etc. I'm getting ahead of myself because I love play, I'll make that video next. So I hope this was supportive for you, being really clear and understanding that we need to know how to respond to our children's anger and aggression without fear, without judgment, without shame, being very present in our body, and having an expansive mindset. All that matters is supporting them to contain the emotion. We're not trying to teach them how to have healthy aggression in that time, we're waiting until they're calm. When they're calm, we can have discussions with them. We can teach them about emotional regulation and healthy aggression through play and storytelling. We can model healthy aggression techniques and involve them in healthy aggression techniques so their brain and their physiology can begin to wire healthy aggression, aggression is safe, aggression is life force energy, aggression is here to support me and elevate and amplify my life and my experience in this world.

Any struggle that you're having with what I said, anything that's in the workbook that you're struggling with, bring it to your coach, bring it into conversation, and we are here for you. I appreciate your mind being open enough to have a very different viewpoint and perspective of anger and aggression. Being aware of when our children hear the word "no", it can bring up all kinds of embedded memories of rejection, helplessness, powerlessness, and it makes sense, it's developmentally appropriate and there's nothing to fear. You are doing a great job and your children are going to mature and evolve, and they're going to be healthy, beautiful, kind people. It's just not linear and it's not always crystal clean. I appreciate you all being on this journey and being committed to yourself and your family. I commend you. I see you. I know this work inside and out, and I'll see you next time for playful parenting and storytelling. Thank you so much.

